Meta and metadata

- Meta is a prefix that in most information technology usages means ’an underlying definition or description’.
  whatis.com

- The term "meta" comes from a Greek word that denotes "alongside, with, after, next." More recent Latin and English usage would employ "meta" to denote something transcendental, or beyond nature. Metadata, then, can be thought of as data about other data.
  From ”Using Dublin Core”, Diane Hillmann

- Metadata is machine understandable information about web resources, or other **things**.
  Tim Berners-Lee, W3C

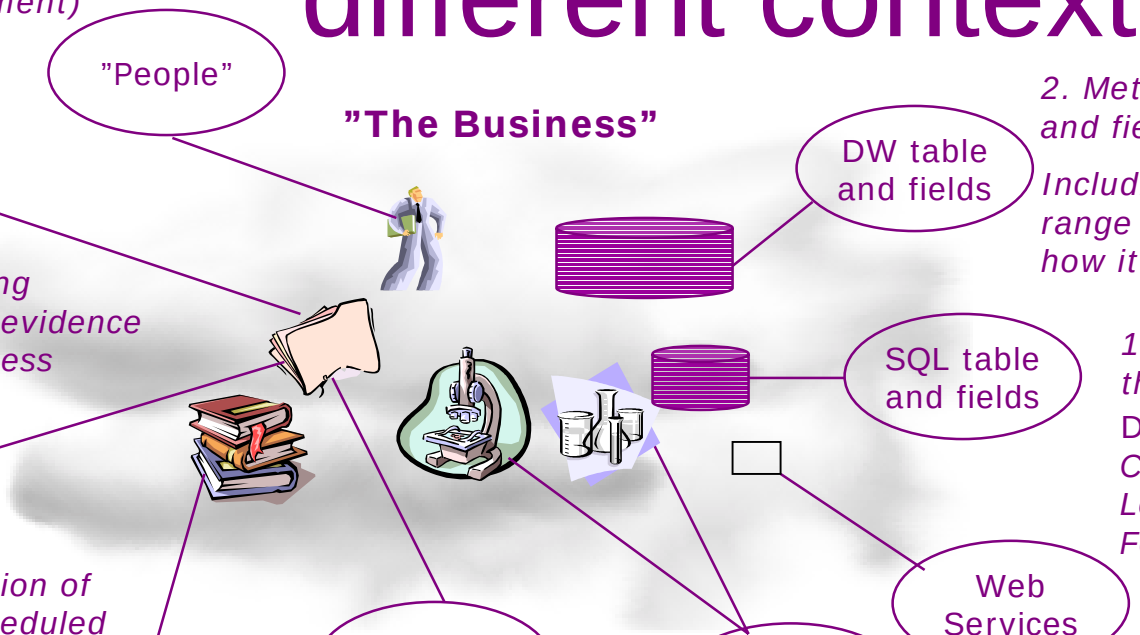
- Metadata are structured, encoded data that describe characteristics of information-bearing entities to aid in the identification, discovery, assessment, and management of the described entities.
  Association for Library Collections and Technical Services, Task Force on Metadata

- It is a structure or framework - encompassing principles for coordinating commitments between systems - for defining and implementing interoperability between otherwise isolated, diverse computing systems.
  From “Enterprises Still Struggle to Leverage Metadata”, by Lou Agosta Giga, December 1999

- Metadata provides information not explicitly present in a textual or visual document, but necessary for storage and processing by attribute type.
  Metadata Management: Crucial for the Real-Time Enterprise, Gartner European Symposium, 10–12 March 2003

The term ”metadata” in different contexts

5. Metadata describing individuals related to the corporation through an agreement (could be an employement agreement)



2. Metadata describing tables and fields a data-warehouse

Including data types and the range of acceptable values and how it has been transformed.

8. Metadata describing ”documentation and evidence of a performed business transaction”

1. Metadata describing the data items

Data: 42
Columnname: Shoesize
Length: 2
Format: Num

4. Metadata definition of the visits to be scheduled within the protocol; the forms associated with each visit; and the information to be collected on each form.

9. Metadata describing Web Services

UDDI (Universal Description, Discovery and Integration) for publishing and discovery of ”modular unit of application logic”

Report

Created: 20020321
Author: Mr X
Version: 2.0

7. Metadata describing documents

E.g. Tissue

From body: xxx
Place: zzz
Samples: yyy

3. Metadata describing ”things”

Book

ISBN: 126767987
Titel: Xxxx yyyy
Classification: zzz

6. Metadata describing instances of intellectual work

Extensible metadata framework describing resources

What metadata, which properties??

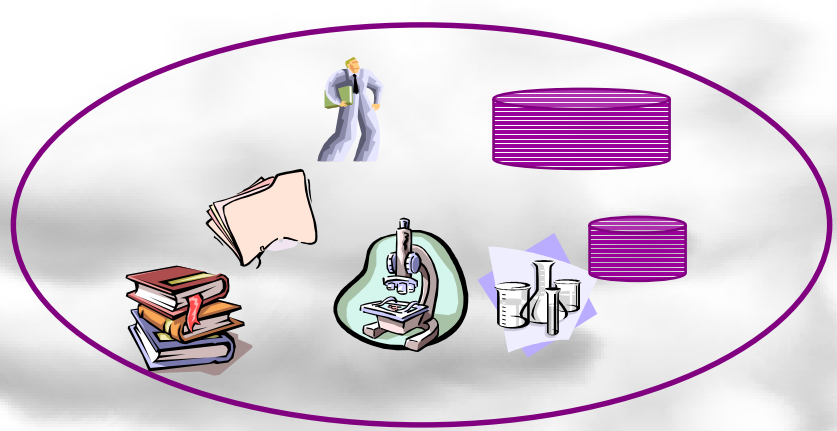
What type of resources??

Descriptions of resources

Properties

Different vocabularies

Different Contexts



Types of resources

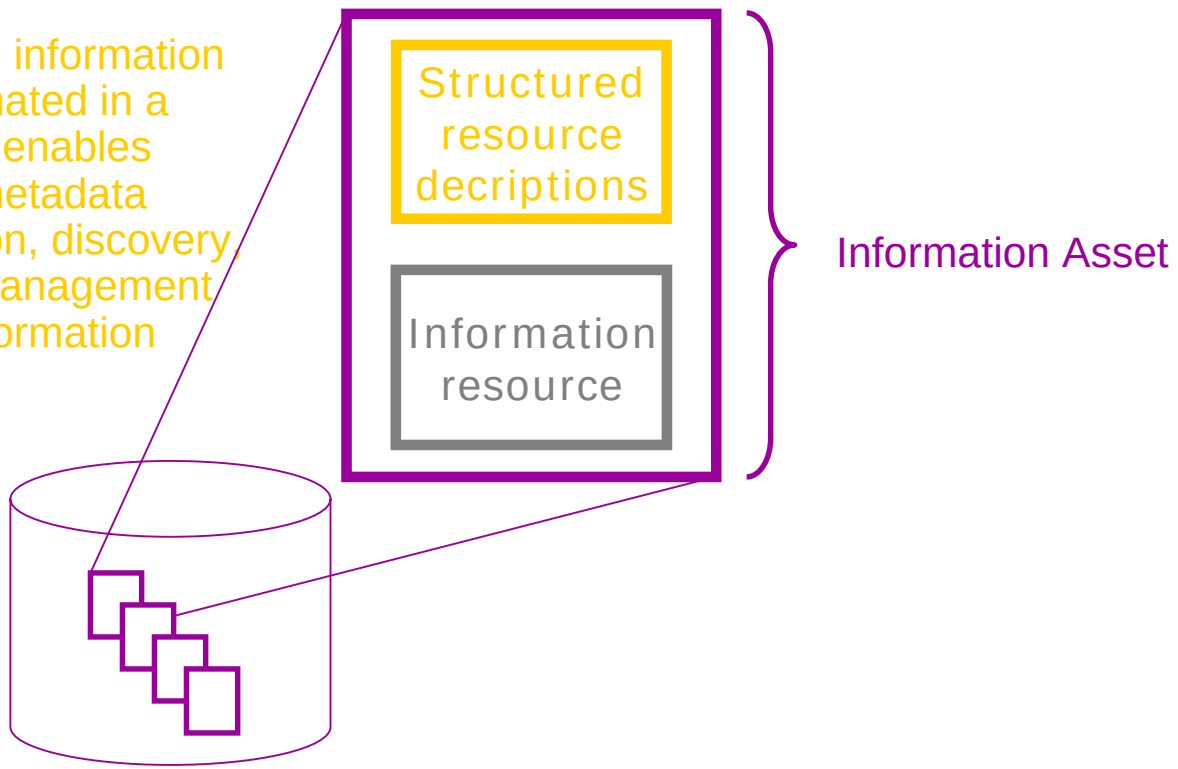
Lifecycle for resources

Relations to other resources

Metadata for Information resources

- Information resources are assets, if they have a structured description which makes them useable, maintainable and reusable.

Metadata describes information resources. It is formated in a structured way that enables reuse. Structrued metadata enables identification, discovery, assessment, and management of the described information resources.



Metadata for Information resources



- Information descriptions (structured metadata) – a way of identifying and describing the different dimensions of information resources
  - *Technical perspective* - Detailing how and where the information is stored: E.g. format, size, identifier, source
  - *Operational producer perspective* - Metadata describing the production of the information resource. The micro-process of the documentation, lifecycle of the container holding the content = document management E.g. Author, Publish date, Version
  - *Current business perspective*, put specific information in context for a subject area. Metadata putting content in a business context at a point in time. Metadata taken from a ”static” taxonomy (e.g. classification) E.g. Project, Drug, Therapy Area
  - *Business evolution perspective* - Business context changes - the lifecycle of metadata - ”dynamic” taxonomies. But we don’t know the future metadata set-up when the information is produces. The macro-process of the business. E.g compound becomes several brands